Lesson 42

THE RESURRECTION

(Adapted from the Foundations of Pentecostal Theology)

Aim: To teach the believers the biblical teaching of the Resurrection.

Almost all religions teach the immortality of the soul; but the Bible teaches the redemption of and the survival of the total person– spirit, soul and body. The ancient Greeks believed in life after death for the soul, but since the body was the source of all evil, release of the soul from the body was desirable. A heretical Christian sect called “Gnostics” shared this concept derived from Greek philosophy. The Bible does not teach that the physical body is the source of evil; the Pauline term “flesh” refers to man’s sinful and selfish nature which, while it manifests itself through actions of the body, derives from a “carnal mind” (Rom. 8:6,7). Christ’s taking our human body (the “likeness of sinful flesh”), “condemned sin in the flesh.” (Rom. 8:3) Christ by His Incarnation, Death and Resurrection redeemed the total person who is in Christ, giving him a hope of a bodily resurrection which will occur at the Rapture of the Church. “For since by man came death, by man came also the resurrection of the dead. For as in Adam

all die, even so in Christ the first fruits; afterward they that are Christ's at His coming" (1 Cor. 15:21-23).

Rom. 8:6,7, 6 The mind governed by the flesh is death, but the mind governed by the Spirit is life and peace. 7The mind governed by the flesh is hostile to God; it does not submit to God's law, nor can it do so.

Rom. 8:3,3 For what the law was powerless to do because it was weakened by the flesh,[a] God did by sending his own Son in the likeness of sinful flesh to be a sin offering.[b] And so he condemned sin in the flesh,

1 Cor. 15:21-23, 21 For since death came through a man, the resurrection of the dead comes also through a man. 22 For as in Adam all die, so in Christ all will be made alive. 23 But each in turn: Christ, the first fruits; then, when he comes, those who belong to him.

A. The Fact of the Resurrection.

The fact of the Resurrection is taught in both the Old and the New Testament:

1. In the Old Testament.

a. By affirmation: *"For I know that my Redeemer lives, and He shall stand at last on the earth; and after my skin is destroyed, this I KNOW that IN MY FLESH I shall see*

God" (Jb. 19:25, NKJV). "As for me, I will behold thy face in righteousness: I shall be satisfied, when I awake with thy likeness" (Ps 17:15). (See also Ps. 16:9-11; Dn. 12:2)

Jb. 19:25 25I know that my redeemer[a] lives, and that in the end he will stand on the earth.

Ps 17:15,15As for me, I will be vindicated and will see your face; when I awake, I will be satisfied with seeing your likeness.

Ps. 16:9-11 9Therefore my heart is glad and my tongue rejoices; my body also will rest secure, 10 because you will not abandon me to the realm of the dead, nor will you let your faithful[a] one see decay. 11You make known to me the path of life; you will fill me with joy in your presence, with eternal pleasures at your right hand.

Dn. 12:2 2Multitudes who sleep in the dust of the earth will awake: some to everlasting life, others to shame and everlasting contempt.

b. By prophecy: "Thy dead men shall live, together with my dead body shall they arise. Awake and sing, ye that dwell in dust: for thy dew is like the dew herbs, and the earth shall cast out the dead" (Is 26:19). (Also Hos. 13:14)

Is 26:19,19But your dead will live, LORD; their bodies will rise— let those who dwell in the lust wake up and shout for joy— your dew is like the dew of the morning; the earth will give birth to her dead.

Hos. 13:14, 14"I will deliver this people from the power of the grave; I will redeem them from death. Where, O death, are your plagues? Where, O grave, is your destruction? "I will have no compassion,

c. By typology: events such as Joseph's deliverance from the pit are typical of death and resurrection (Gn. 37:20-36), as are Isaac's return from the altar of sacrifice (Gn22:5-14), and Jonah's deliverance from the great fish (commonly called, whale) (Jon 2; Mt. 12:40)

Gn. 37:20-36,20 "Come now, let's kill him and throw him into one of these cisterns and say that a ferocious animal devoured him. Then we'll see what comes of his dreams." 21 When Reuben heard this, he tried to rescue him from their hands. "Let's not take his life," he said. 22"Don't shed any blood. Throw him into this cistern here in the wilderness, but don't lay a hand on him." Reuben said this to rescue him from them and take him back to his father. 23 So when Joseph came to his brothers, they stripped him of his robe—the ornate robe he was wearing— 24 and they took him and threw him

into the cistern. The cistern was empty; there was no water in it. 25As they sat down to eat their meal, they looked up and saw a caravan of Ishmaelites coming from Gilead. Their camels were loaded with spices, balm and myrrh, and they were on their way to take them down to Egypt. 26Judah said to his brothers, "What will we gain if we kill our brother and cover up his blood? 27Come, let's sell him to the Ishmaelites and not lay our hands on him; after all, he is our brother, our own flesh and blood." His brothers agreed. 28 So when the Midianite merchants came by, his brothers pulled Joseph up out of the cistern and sold him for twenty shekels[a] of silver to the Ishmaelites, who took him to Egypt. 29 When Reuben returned to the cistern and saw that Joseph was not there, he tore his clothes. 30 He went back to his brothers and said, "The boy isn't there! Where can I turn now?" 31 Then they got Joseph's robe, slaughtered a goat and dipped the robe in the blood. 32 They took the ornate robe back to their father and said, "We found this. Examine it to see whether it is your son's robe." 33 He recognized it and said, "It is my son's robe! Some ferocious animal has devoured him. Joseph has surely been torn to pieces." 34 Then Jacob tore his clothes, put on sackcloth and mourned for his son many days. 35 All his sons and

daughters came to comfort him, but he refused to be comforted. “No,” he said, “I will continue to mourn until I join my son in the grave.” So his father wept for him. 36 Meanwhile, the Midianites[b] sold Joseph in Egypt to Potiphar, one of Pharaoh’s officials, the captain of the guard.

Gn. 22:5-14,5 He said to his servants, “Stay here with the donkey while I and the boy go over there. We will worship and then we will come back to you.” 6 Abraham took the wood for the burnt offering and placed it on his son Isaac, and he himself carried the fire and the knife. As the two of them went on together,7 Isaac spoke up and said to his father Abraham, “Father?” “Yes, my son?” Abraham replied. “The fire and wood are here,” Isaac said, “but where is the lamb for the burnt offering?” 8 Abraham answered, “God himself will provide the lamb for the burnt offering, my son.” And the two of them went on together. 9 When they reached the place God had told him about, Abraham built an altar there and arranged the wood on it. He bound his son Isaac and laid him on the altar, on top of the wood. 10 Then he reached out his hand and took the knife to slay his son. 11 But the angel of the LORD called out to him from heaven, “Abraham! Abraham!” “Here I am,” he replied. 12 “Do not lay a

hand on the boy," he said. "Do not do anything to him. Now I know that you fear God, because you have not withheld from me your son, your only son." 13 Abraham looked up and there in a thicket he saw a ram[a] caught by its horns. He went over and took the ram and sacrificed it as a burnt offering instead of his son. 14 So Abraham called that place The LORD Will Provide. And to this day it is said, "On the mountain of the LORD it will be provided."

Mt. 12:40, 40 For as Jonah was three days and three nights in the belly of a huge fish, so the Son of Man will be three days and three nights in the heart of the earth.

d. By example: the Old Testament contains several examples of persons who were raised form the dead: 1 Kgs. 17:17-24; 2Kgs 4:32-35; 13:20, 21. While these are cases of resuscitation rather than resurrection (for those who were raised died natural deaths later), they demonstrate God's power and disposition to restore dead bodies to life.

1 Kgs. 17:17-24,17 Sometime later the son of the woman who owned the house became ill. He grew worse and worse, and finally stopped breathing. 18 She said to Elijah, "What do you have against me, man of God? Did you come to remind me of my sin and kill my son?" 19

“Give me your son,” Elijah replied. He took him from her arms, carried him to the upper room where he was staying, and laid him on his bed. 20 Then he cried out to the LORD, “LORD my God, have you brought tragedy even on this widow I am staying with, by causing her son to die?” 21Then he stretched himself out on the boy three times and cried out to the LORD, “LORD my God, let this boy’s life return to him!” 22 The LORD heard Elijah’s cry, and the boy’s life returned to him, and he lived. 23Elijah picked up the child and carried him down from the room into the house. He gave him to his mother and said, “Look, your son is alive!” 24 Then the woman said to Elijah, “Now I know that you are a man of God and that the word of the LORD from your mouth is the truth.”

2Kgs 4:32-35, 32 When Elisha reached the house, there was the boy lying dead on his couch. 33He went in, shut the door on the two of them and prayed to the LORD. 34Then he got on the bed and lay on the boy, mouth to mouth, eyes to eyes, hands to hands. As he stretched himself out on him, the boy’s body grew warm. 35 Elisha turned away and walked back and forth in the room and then got on the bed and stretched out on him once more. The boy sneezed seven times and opened his eyes.

2Kgs 13:20,21, 20Elisha died and was buried. Now Moabite raiders used to enter the country every spring. 21 Once while some Israelites were burying a man, suddenly they saw a band of raiders; so they threw the man's body into Elisha's tomb. When the body touched Elisha's bones, the man came to life and stood up on his feet.

2. In the New Testament.

a. By affirmation: "So also is the resurrection of the dead. It is sown in corruption; it is raised in incorruption; it is raised in incorruption: it is sown dishonor; it is raise in glory: it is sown in weakness: it is raised in power…" (1 Cor 15:42, 43) (See also Mt. 22:30-32; Jn. 5:21; Acts 23:6-8; 26:8, 23; 2Tm 1:10; 1Pt 1:3.)

1 Cor 15:42, 43, 42 So will it be with the resurrection of the dead. The body that is sown is perishable, it is raised imperishable; 43it is sown in dishonor, it is raised in glory; it is sown in weakness, it is raised in power;

Mt. 22:30-32,30 At the resurrection people will neither marry nor be given in marriage; they will be like the angels in heaven.31 But about the resurrection of the dead—have you not read what God said to you, 32'I am the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of

Jacob'[a]? He is not the God of the dead but of the living."

Jn. 5:21,21 For just as the Father raises the dead and gives them life, even so the Son gives life to whom he is pleased to give it.

Acts 23:6-8, 23,6 Then Paul, knowing that some of them were Sadducees and the others Pharisees, called out in the Sanhedrin, "My brothers, I am a Pharisee, descended from Pharisees. I stand on trial because of the hope of the resurrection of the dead." 7When he said this, a dispute broke out between the Pharisees and the Sadducees, and the assembly was divided. 8 (The Sadducees say that there is no resurrection, and that there are neither angels nor spirits, but the Pharisees believe all these things.) 23 Then he called two of his centurions and ordered them, "Get ready a detachment of two hundred soldiers, seventy horsemen and two hundred spearmen[a] to go to Caesarea at nine tonight.

2Tm 1:10,10 but it has now been revealed through the appearing of our Savior, Christ Jesus, who has destroyed death and has brought life and immortality to light through the gospel.

1Pt 1:3,3Praise be to the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ! In his great mercy he has given us new birth

into a living hope through the resurrection of Jesus Christ from the dead,

b. By prophecy: "Marvel not at this: for the hour is coming, in which all that are in the graves shall hear His voice, and shall come forth; they that have done good, unto the resurrection of life; and they that have done evil, unto the resurrection of damnation" (Jn 5:28, 29). (See also Jn. 6:39, 40, 44,54; Lk. 14:13, 14; 20:35, 36; 1 Cor 15; Phil 3:11, 21; 1 Thes 4:14-16, Rv. 20:4-6, 13-15.)

Jn 5:28, 29, 28 "Do not be amazed at this, for a time is coming when all who are in their graves will hear his voice 29 and come out—those who have done what is good will rise to live, and those who have done what is evil will rise to be condemned.

Jn. 6:39, 40, 44,54, 39 And this is the will of him who sent me, that I shall lose none of all those he has given me, but raise them up at the last day. 40 For my Father's will is that everyone who looks to the Son and believes in him shall have eternal life, and I will raise them up at the last day." 44 "No one can come to me unless the Father who sent me draws them, and I will raise them up at the last day. 54 Whoever eats my flesh and drinks my blood has eternal life, and I will raise them up at the last day.

Lk. 14:13, 14,13 But when you give a banquet, invite the poor, the crippled, the lame, the blind, 14 and you will be blessed. Although they cannot repay you, you will be repaid at the resurrection of the righteous."

Lk. 20:35, 3635 But those who are considered worthy of taking part in the age to come and in the resurrection from the dead will neither marry nor be given in marriage, 36and they can no longer die; for they are like the angels. They are God's children, since they are children of the resurrection.

Phil 3:11,21, 11 and so, somehow, attaining to the resurrection from the dead. 21 who, by the power that enables him to bring everything under his control, will transform our lowly bodies so that they will be like his glorious body.

1 Thes 4:14-16, 14 For we believe that Jesus died and rose again, and so we believe that God will bring with Jesus those who have fallen asleep in him. 15 According to the Lord's word, we tell you that we who are still alive, who are left until the coming of the Lord, will certainly not precede those who have fallen asleep. 16 For the Lord himself will come down from heaven, with a loud command, with the voice of the archangel and with the trumpet call of God, and the dead in Christ will rise first.

Rv. 20:4-6,4 I saw thrones on which were seated those who had been given authority to judge. And I saw the souls of those who had been beheaded because of their testimony about Jesus and because of the word of God. They[a] had not worshiped the beast or its image and had not received its mark on their foreheads or their hands. They came to life and reigned with Christ a thousand years. 5 (The rest of the dead did not come to life until the thousand years were ended.) This is the first resurrection. 6 Blessed and holy are those who share in the first resurrection. The second death has no power over them, but they will be priests of God and of Christ and will reign with him for a thousand years.

c. The New Testament also contains examples of persons raised form the dead. They were not resurrections such as will occur at the Second Coming and at the Last Judgment, for they later died and will experience the final Resurrection just as others; however, they were prefigures of the final Resurrection. On the other hand, the Resurrection of Jesus was the true and ideal resurrection. When Jesus arose He became "the first fruits of them that slept" (1 Cor 15:20). His Resurrection was the guarantee of all resurrections of believers: "But God… raised us up together, and made us sit together in heavenly places in

Christ Jesus" (Eph 2:6). (See Jn 11:41-44, Lazarus; Lk. 8:41-56, Jairus' daughter; Lk. 7:12-15, the window's son; Mt. 27:52, 53 Old Testament saints.)

1 Cor 15:20,20 But Christ has indeed been raised from the dead, the first fruits of those who have fallen asleep.

Eph 2:6,6 And God raised us up with Christ and seated us with him in the heavenly realms in Christ Jesus,

Jn 11:41-44,41 So they took away the stone. Then Jesus looked up and said, "Father, I thank you that you have heard me. 42 I knew that you always hear me, but I said this for the benefit of the people standing here, that they may believe that you sent me." 43 When he had said this, Jesus called in a loud voice, "Lazarus, come out!" 44 The dead man came out, his hands and feet wrapped with strips of linen, and a cloth around his face. Jesus said to them, "Take off the grave clothes and let him go."

Lk. 8:41-56,41 Then a man named Jairus, a synagogue leader, came and fell at Jesus' feet, pleading with him to come to his house 42 because his only daughter, a girl of about twelve, was dying. As Jesus was on his way, the crowds almost crushed him.43And a woman was there who had been subject to bleeding for twelve years,[a] but no one could heal her.44 She came

up behind him and touched the edge of his cloak, and immediately her bleeding stopped. 45 “Who touched me?” Jesus asked. When they all denied it, Peter said, “Master, the people are crowding and pressing against you.” 46But Jesus said, “Someone touched me; I know that power has gone out from me.” 47 Then the woman, seeing that she could not go unnoticed, came trembling and fell at his feet. In the presence of all the people, she told why she had touched him and how she had been instantly healed. 48 Then he said to her, “Daughter, your faith has healed you. Go in peace.” 49While Jesus was still speaking, someone came from the house of Jairus, the synagogue leader. “Your daughter is dead,” he said. “Don’t bother the teacher anymore.” 50 Hearing this, Jesus said to Jairus, “Don’t be afraid; just believe, and she will be healed.” 51 When he arrived at the house of Jairus, he did not let anyone go in with him except Peter, John and James, and the child’s father and mother. 52 Meanwhile, all the people were wailing and mourning for her. “Stop wailing,” Jesus said. “She is not dead but asleep.” 53 They laughed at him, knowing that she was dead. 54 But he took her by the hand and said, “My child, get up!”55 Her spirit returned, and at once she stood up. Then Jesus told them to give her something to eat. 56Her

parents were astonished, but he ordered them not to tell anyone what had happened.

Lk. 7:12-15,12As he approached the town gate, a dead person was being carried out—the only son of his mother, and she was a widow. And a large crowd from the town was with her. 13 When the Lord saw her, his heart went out to her and he said, "Don't cry." 14Then he went up and touched the bier they were carrying him on, and the bearers stood still. He said, "Young man, I say to you, get up!" 15The dead man sat up and began to talk, and Jesus gave him back to his mother.

Mt. 27:52-53, 52 and the tombs broke open. The bodies of many holy people who had died were raised to life. 53 They came out of the tombs after Jesus' resurrection and[a] went into the holy city and appeared to many people.

B. The Nature of the Resurrection.

The Resurrection will be universal. All do not have eternal life, but all have eternal existence. All persons will be resurrected, the just to eternal life, the unjust to eternal condemnation. All will be raised, but not all at the same time (Jn 5:28, 29).

Jn 5:28, 29,28 "Do not be amazed at this, for a time is coming when all who are in their graves will hear his voice 29 and come out—those who have done what is good will rise to live, and those who have done what is evil will rise to be condemned.

1. The Resurrection of Believers (1 Thes 4:13-18; 1 Cor 15:50-57; Rv. 20: 4-6).

The Resurrection of the Church occurs at the Coming of Jesus, immediately prior to the Rapture (1 Thes 4:16). The Believers' Resurrection is called the "first resurrection": "Blessed and holy is he that hath part in the first resurrection: on such the second death hath no power…" (Rv. 20:6). It has been taught by some that there will be one general resurrection of the dead and one judgment at which just and unjust are judged. Jesus sometimes mentioned the two resurrections and judgments in the same passage, but a careful reading will reveal that Jesus was not speaking of one general resurrection: "And shall come forth; they that have done good unto the resurrection of life; and they that have done evil unto the resurrection of damnation; (Jn 5:29). Notice that one is a resurrection of life while other is a resurrection of condemnation; they are not the same, nor

do they occur at the same time, as Paul and John both elucidate.

It is normal for prophetic perspective to view several related future events as if they were one event. With similar prophetic language, the first and second comings of Jesus are merged in the same passage in Old Testament prophecy (Is 9:6,7; 61:1-3; Dn 12:2). New Testament writers sometimes allude to both the Rapture and Final Coming in the same reference (1Thes 3:13). Both Paul and John make I clear that the Saint's Resurrection (including the saved remnant of Israel and the Tribulation saints) takes place at Christ's Coming and before the Millennial Reign (1 Cor 15:51, 52; Rv. 20:4-6; Dan 12:1-2). That the Saint's Resurrection is selective is seen in a remarkable statement of the Apostle Paul: "that I may know Him, and the power of His resurrection, and the fellowship of His sufferings, being made conformable unto His death; if by any means I might attain unto the resurrection of dead" (Phil 3:10,11). If there is only one general resurrection for the just and the unjust, would Paul aspire to attain to it? A more literal translation reveals Paul's full meaning: "… If by any means I might advance to the EARLIER resurrection, which is FROM AMONG the dead" (Phil 3:11, Rotherham). The Greek preposition

ek means “out from,” Paul desired to be in the group that would be resurrected at the time of the Rapture; those who would be taken selectively “out from among “ the general mass of the dead; those who would be raised in the EARLIER resurrection (the first resurrection, Rv 20:6). The Greek word for “resurrection”; the double use of the word ek gives added emphasis to the idea that the Resurrection of the Christian believers is one in which they selected for a special awakening. That there will be several orders of resurrection is expressed in another place by Paul: “But every man in his own order: Christ the first fruits; afterward they that are Christ’s

at His coming” (1Cor 15:23).

1 Thes 4:13-18, 13 Brothers and sisters, we do not want you to be uninformed about those who sleep in death, so that you do not grieve like the rest of mankind, who have no hope.14 For we believe that Jesus died and rose again, and so we believe that God will bring with Jesus those who have fallen asleep in him. 15 According to the Lord’s word, we tell you that we who are still alive, who are left until the coming of the Lord, will certainly not precede those who have fallen asleep. 16 For the Lord himself will come down from heaven, with a loud command, with the voice of the archangel and with the

trumpet call of God, and the dead in Christ will rise first. 17After that, we who are still alive and are left will be caught up together with them in the clouds to meet the Lord in the air. And so we will be with the Lord forever. 18Therefore encourage one another with these words.

1 Cor 15:50-57,50 I declare to you, brothers and sisters, that flesh and blood cannot inherit the kingdom of God, nor does the perishable inherit the imperishable. 51 Listen, I tell you a mystery: We will not all sleep, but we will all be changed— 52 in a flash, in the twinkling of an eye, at the last trumpet. For the trumpet will sound, the dead will be raised imperishable, and we will be changed. 53 For the perishable must clothe itself with the imperishable, and the mortal with immortality. 54 When the perishable has been clothed with the imperishable, and the mortal with immortality, then the saying that is written will come true: "Death has been swallowed up in victory."[a] 55 "Where, O death, is your victory? Where, O death, is your sting?"[b] 56 The sting of death is sin, and the power of sin is the law. 57But thanks be to God! He gives us the victory through our Lord Jesus Christ.

Jn 5:29,4 I saw thrones on which were seated those who had been given authority to judge. And I saw the souls of those who had been beheaded because of their

testimony about Jesus and because of the word of God. They[a] had not worshiped the beast or its image and had not received its mark on their foreheads or their hands. They came to life and reigned with Christ a thousand years. 5 (The rest of the dead did not come to life until the thousand years were ended.) This is the first resurrection. 6 Blessed and holy are those who share in the first resurrection. The second death has no power over them, but they will be priests of God and of Christ and will reign with him for a thousand years.

1 Thes 4:16, 16 For the Lord himself will come down from heaven, with a loud command, with the voice of the archangel and with the trumpet call of God, and the dead in Christ will rise first.

Rv. 20:6, 29 and come out—those who have done what is good will rise to live, and those who have done what is evil will rise to be condemned.

Isaiah 9:6-7, For to us a child is born, to us a son is given, and the government will be on his shoulders. And he will be called Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace. 7 Of the greatness of his government and peace there will be no end. He will reign on David's throne and over his kingdom, establishing and upholding it with justice and

righteousness from that time on and forever. The zeal of the LORD Almighty will accomplish this.

a. It will be a literal bodily resurrection. This is shown by the Resurrection of Jesus. His resurrected body still bore the prints of the nails and the wound of the sword (Jn 20:26-28); after His Resurrection, Jesus had a body of "flesh and bones" and even took food (Lk. 24:36-43). On the other hand, the body of Jesus was sufficiently glorified that His disciples did not always recognize Him at once. His appearances show that His body was not subject to normal physical limitations (Jn 20:19, 26). That our resurrection reaction will be literal does not mean that all the same molecules of our dead bodies will be recovered; in fact, our body cells are replaced a number of times during our life span without our losing personal identity. Of this one may be certain, that God will recover from the dust a body with a definite relationship to one's earthly body, but transformed and fashioned to one's new environment (Phil 3:21).

Paul speaks of death as a sowing of the body as a farmer sows seed. The seed dies, but it contains a life principle by which nature brings forth a new plant of the same genus, species and variety as the original

seek. At the Resurrection, cemeteries will be turned into harvest fields (1Cor 15:42-44); and out of the planted earthly bodies, the Lord will raise up resurrection bodies that are identified with the earthly body, but which are transformed with a likeness to Christ's resurrection body. Believer's bodies will be changed (1 Cor 15:52), but each will have a relationship to the earthly body. The resurrection body will not be the earthly body merely resuscitated; but the likeness of the earthly body glorified. It appears from the identification of Moses and Elijah on the Mount of Transfiguration and of Jesus after His Resurrection that our resurrection bodies will retain their personal identity.

b. The resurrection body will be God-given. "But God giveth it a body as it hath pleased him…" (1 Cor 15:38). This is in answer to a hypothetical question "… How are the dead raised up? And with what body do they be conceived by human intellect. Christ's Resurrection is the great miracle of our Gospel. We do not explain it. We accept it as Divine revelation. In the same manner we accept bodily resurrection as a miracle of Divine power and wisdom. If we accept Christ's Resurrection (which is one of the best

attested events of history), we should have no problem with the acceptance of our final resurrection; for we shall be raised up by the same Omnipotent God who raised up Jesus form the dead.

1 Cor 15:38,38But God gives it a body as he has determined, and to each kind of seed he gives its own body.

c. The believer's resurrection body will be immortal and incorruptible (1 Cor 15:42). The Scriptures never speak of the immortality of the soul. The believer now has eternal life, but he dwells in a mortal body. All men have eternal existence. Only believers who shall experience "The First Resurrection" will receive immortal and incorruptible bodies (1 Cor 15:42).

1 Cor 15:42, 42So will it be with the resurrection of the dead. The body that is sown is perishable, it is raised imperishable;

d. The resurrection body will be a celestial body (1Cor.15:40). Our earthly bodies are suited to this present earthly environment. The resurrection body will be suited to both the new heavens and the new earth, as well as to the millennial earth. Like the body of Jesus, it will be able to come and go between Heaven and the earth.

1Cor.15:40, 40 There are also heavenly bodies and there are earthly bodies; but the splendor bodies of the heavenly bodies is one kind, and the splendor of the earthly is another.

e. The resurrection body will be a powerful body. "… It is sown in weakness, it is raised in power…" (1 Cor 15:43). The contrast here expressed indicates that the new capacities of the resurrection body will be inconceivably and inexpressibly greater than those of any earthly human body. The events recorded of angels are a preview of the capacities of resurrected saints (Mt. 22:29,30).

1 Cor 15:43,43it is sown in dishonor, it is raised in glory; it is sown in weakness, it is raised in power;

Mt. 22:29,30, 29 Jesus replied, "You are in error because you do not know the Scriptures or the power of God. 30At the resurrection people will neither marry nor be given in marriage; they will be like the angels in heaven.

f. The resurrection body will be a glorious body. "It is sown in dishonor, it is raised in glory…" (1 Cor 15:43). The resurrected body will be as glorious as the decaying earthly body can be inglorious. Jesus promised, "Then shall the righteous shine forth as the

sun in the kingdom of their Father" (Mt 13:43). The above words of Jesus suggest for the saints the glory that He manifested on the Mount of Transfiguration: "And was transfigured before them: and His face did shine as the sun, and his raiment was white as the light" (Mt 17:2). Jesus prayed for us, "And the glory which Thou gavest me I have given them; that they may be one, even as we are one…" (Jn 17:22).

After speaking of the Resurrection, Daniel said, "And they that be wise shall shine like the brightness of the firmament; and they that turn many to righteousness as the stars for ever and ever" (Dn 12:3)

Mt13:43,43Then the righteous will shine like the sun in the kingdom of their Father. Whoever has ears, let them hear.

Mt 17:2, 2There he was transfigured before them. His face shone like the sun, and his clothes became as white as the light.

Jn 17:22,22 I have given them the glory that you gave me, that they may be one as we are one—Dn 12:3, 3Those who are wise[a] will shine like the brightness of the heavens, and those who lead many to righteousness,like the stars for ever and ever.

2. The Resurrection of Unbelievers (Rv 20:5, 12, 13, 14; Jn. 5:28, 29; Dn 12:2; Acts 24:15).

The Bible does not reveal specifically the state or nature of the resurrection bodies of the unrighteous; but it may be assumed that they will be bodies subject to corruption or ruin. Jesus said, “And fear not them which kill the body, but are not able to kill the soul: but rather him which is able to destroy [Gr., apollumi, “to ruin utterly”] both BODY and soul in hell [Grk.,gehenna]” (Mt 10:28). The bodies of the unrighteous dead will suffer “utter ruin” eternally.

(See 2 Thes 1:8,9.) The unrighteous are not resurrected at the time of Christ’s Second Coming, but after the Millennial Reign of Christ (Rev. 20:5).

Mt 10:28,28Do not be afraid of those who kill the body but cannot kill the soul. Rather, be afraid of the One who can destroy both soul and body in hell.

2 Thes 1:8,9,8 He will punish those who do not know God and do not obey the gospel of our Lord Jesus. 9They will be punished with everlasting destruction and shut out from the presence of the Lord and from the glory of his might.

Rev. 20:5, 5 (The rest of the dead did not come to life until the thousand years were ended.) This is the first resurrection.

C. The Time of the Resurrection.

The order of resurrections is as follows:

1. The Resurrection of Jesus (Mt 28:1-10; Mk 16:1-14; Lk. 24:1-39; Jn 20:1-17).

2. A Resurrection of saints of the Old Testament (Mt. 27:52, 53).

3. The Resurrection of the Church saints at the Rapture (Jn 14:3; 1 Thes 4:16, 1Cor 15:52).

4. The Resurrection of the two witnesses of Revelation 11:12, during the tribulation period.

5. The Resurrection of the saints of Israel and of the Tribulation saints who are witnesses for Christ and who do not worship the Beast (Rv. 20:4-6; Dn 12:1,2).

6. The Resurrection of the unrighteous. This will occur after the Millennial Reign of Christ. They will be resurrected to stand before the Great White Throne (Rv 20:5,11-14).

Mt 28:1-10,After the Sabbath, at dawn on the first day of the week, Mary Magdalene and the other Mary went to look at the tomb.2There was a violent earthquake, for an angel of the Lord came down from heaven and, going to the tomb, rolled back the stone and sat on it. 3 His appearance was like lightning, and his clothes were white as snow. 4 The guards were so afraid of him that they shook and became like dead men.5 The angel said to the women, "Do not be afraid, for I know that you are looking for Jesus, who was crucified.6He is not here; he has risen, just as he said. Come and see the place where he lay. 7 Then go quickly and tell his disciples: 'He has risen from the dead and is going ahead of you into Galilee. There you will see him.' Now I have told you." 8 So the women hurried away from the tomb, afraid yet filled with joy, and ran to tell his disciples. 9 Suddenly Jesus met them. "Greetings," he said. They came to him, clasped his feet and worshiped him. 10 Then Jesus said to them, "Do not be afraid. Go and tell my brothers to go to Galilee; there they will see me."

Mk16:1-14,When the Sabbath was over, Mary Magdalene, Mary the mother of James, and Salome bought spices so that they might go to anoint Jesus' body. 2 Very early on the first day of the week, just after sunrise,

they were on their way to the tomb 3 and they asked each other, "Who will roll the stone away from the entrance of the tomb?" 4 But when they looked up, they saw that the stone, which was very large, had been rolled away. 5 As they entered the tomb, they saw a young man dressed in a white robe sitting on the right side, and they were alarmed. 6 "Don't be alarmed," he said. "You are looking for Jesus the Nazarene, who was crucified. He has risen! He is not here. See the place where they laid him. 7 But go, tell his disciples and Peter, 'He is going ahead of you into Galilee. There you will see him, just as he told you.'" 8Trembling and bewildered, the women went out and fled from the tomb. They said nothing to anyone, because they were afraid.[a]

Mt. 27:52, 53, 52 and the tombs broke open. The bodies of many holy people who had died were raised to life. 53 They came out of the tombs after Jesus' resurrection and[a] went into the holy city and appeared to many people.

Jn 14:3,3And if I go and prepare a place for you, I will come back and take you to be with me that you also may be where I am.

Revelation 11:12,12 Then they heard a loud voice from heaven saying to them, "Come up here." And they

went up to heaven in a cloud, while their enemies looked on.